

The Dhāraṇī Called 'The Arising of Nectar'

Amṛtabhava nāma dhāraṇī · Toh 645 · Derge Kangyur

བདད་རྩིབ་ཅུ་བ་ཞེས་བ་བྱའུ་གི་ཐུགས་

The Arising of Nectar, known in Sanskrit as the Amṛtabhava nāma dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Bdud rtsi 'byung ba zhes bya ba'i gzungs, is a dhāraṇī text concerned with the consecration of food and provisions for the benefit of all sentient beings. Set at Rājagṛha, the text opens with the householder Zangkyong requesting that the Buddha bless offerings of incense, medicine, and food for his fourfold retinue and for beings throughout the six realms, whereupon the Buddha enters a meditative absorption bearing the same name as the text itself. It belongs to the dhāraṇī genre of Buddhist scripture, which employs sacred formulas and ritual consecration as a means of generating merit and benefit for living beings. This text is Toh 645 in the Kangyur, where it is classified among the dhāraṇī collections.

In the language of India: Amṛtabhava nāma dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The dhāraṇī called "The Arising of Nectar."

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One was dwelling at Rājagṛha, beside the tree of awakening, surrounded by the fourfold retinue, together with gods and humans. Then from within that retinue, the householder Zangkyong arranged a great offering of incense, medicine, and food for the Blessed One's fourfold retinue and for all sentient beings of the six classes, and addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, please consecrate these foods and provisions for the benefit of all sentient beings."

Thereupon the Blessed One entered into the meditative absorption called "The Arising of Nectar." Upon the food, above a lunar maṇḍala, a white syllable RAM appeared, and the sound arose: "All phenomena are free from defilement." By this, the impurities of the food were purified. Then, upon the lunar maṇḍala, a white syllable A was visualized, and the food was transformed into divine nectar and all manner of sustenance. Then, upon the lunar maṇḍala, the syllable OM caused all noble ones and all sentient beings to be pleased and satisfied.

Thereupon the Blessed One, with hands held in the vajra gesture, pronounced this dhāraṇī:

Oṃ sarvadharmata vajrasiddha hūṃ. Oṃ amṛta hūṃ. Namaḥ sarvatathāgatebhyo viśvamukhebhyaḥ sarvathā kham utgate spharaṇa imaṃ gagana khaṃ svāhā. Oṃ namaḥ sarvatathāgata avalokite sambhara sambhara hūṃ. Oṃ ruru sphuru jvāla tiṣṭha siddha locanī sarva arthasādhane svāhā.

The very moment this dhāraṇī was pronounced, all noble ones were pleased and every sentient being was made happy by the offering food.

Then the householder Zangkyong, joining his palms before the Blessed One, spoke these words: "By the power of all buddhas and bodhisattvas, by the power of the blessing of the utterly pure dharmadhātu, and by the power of my own pure intention, may immeasurable and inconceivable Dharma wealth and material wealth — beyond telling, beyond exhausting in speech — arise and flourish in the palaces of all noble ones, in the dwelling places of all sentient beings, and in the mental continuum of all sentient beings. By the blessing of the truth of the Buddha, the truth of the Dharma, and the truth of the Saṅgha, of secret mantra, knowledge mantra, mudrā, and meditative absorption, and by this gift of Dharma — the perfections and so forth — and by this my gift of material things, may all be happy and joyful."

The Blessed One gave the response "Excellent!" and said: "Excellent, householder Zangkyong! Excellent that you perform such an arduous practice as this! Those among my retinue — gods and humans alike — should also make offerings in this manner."

Having declared this, the entire assembled retinue, along with the householder Zangkyong, rejoiced and gave joyful praise to what the Blessed One had taught.

The dhāraṇī called "The Arising of Nectar" is complete.

Translator's Notes

- The syllable RAM in the visualization sequence is a seed syllable associated with fire in tantric ritual, here functioning to purify. Its appearance here in a lunar maṇḍala context — typically associated with cooling — may reflect a specific ritual logic of this dhāraṇī text: fire-purification precedes transformation into nectar. This is not an error in the translation; the Tibetan clearly reads RAM (ཀླུ་མ་).

The name Zangkyong (འགྲུ་མ་ཀླུ་མ་) is a Tibetan rendering of a Sanskrit name, likely Subharaṣṭita or a similar compound meaning "protector of the good." It is left in its Tibetan form here as the Sanskrit original is not specified in the text and the reconstruction would be speculative.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.